

Rating Area 7: South Central Pennsylvania

Hub: York / Lancaster | Counties: Adams, Berks, Lancaster, York

21.5% PID-approved avg. individual rate hike	102% avg. net premium increase, 2026	443,024 PA enrollees as of June 1, 2026	160,000+ cumulative PA terminations
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THE STATEWIDE PICTURE

The federal enhanced premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025, and Congress has not restored them; combined with the Pennsylvania Insurance Department's (PID) approved 21.5% average individual-market rate increase, Pennie reports the average net premium for the affected population rose 102% for 2026 (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; Pennie, 2026a). Statewide, 85,000 people dropped Pennie coverage during Open Enrollment; as of June 1, 2026, cumulative cancellations exceed 160,000 and total enrollment stands at 443,024 (Pennie, 2026a, 2026b). Pennsylvania's own relief program, the Act 54 state subsidy, remains unfunded as the state budget missed its June 30, 2026 deadline for the fifth year running (Spotlight PA, 2026).

CARRIERS & RATES IN THIS AREA

"Dutch Country," with a large self-employed and small-business population, is served by Keystone Health Plan Central, Capital Advantage Assurance, Geisinger, and Independence/QCC plans (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025b). PID's own public rate materials place the region's defining 2026 example here.

PID'S OWN EXAMPLE: THE SUBSIDY CLIFF IN YORK COUNTY

PID's release on the 2026 rates cites a 60-year-old married couple in York County earning about \$82,000 whose annual premium rose from \$7,032 to \$35,712 — a documented 408% increase (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025). This is the mechanical result of crossing the 400% federal poverty line: below it, a sliding scale applies; one dollar above it, the credit disappears entirely. If your household is near that line, a small change in reported income can be the difference between a subsidy and none at all.

YOUR CONSUMER PROTECTIONS

If a directory error sends you out-of-network: 28 Pa. Code § 9.725 caps your liability at in-network cost-sharing, and Act 252 of 2023 presumes an undisclosed out-of-network balance bill illegal. The federal IDR process (45 C.F.R. § 149.510) is a *provider-vs-plan* tool only — you cannot file one yourself; use the protections above instead.

Enroll / compare plans: pennie.com or 1-844-844-8040	File a complaint: pa.gov/consumer or 1-866-722-6675
Free legal help: phlp.org or 1-800-274-3258	Medicare counseling: PA MEDI 1-800-783-7067

SOURCES (APA)

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